Mr. Lamb : Nothing to be afraid of. Just a garden. Just me.

In Direct Speech, we quote the actual words of a speaker. Indirect Speech, also called Reported Speech, is used to report in writing or speech what someone else said without actually quoting the speaker's words.

In Direct Speech, quotation marks are used to quote the exact speech. In Indirect Speech quotation marks are not used.

The above conversation is in Direct Speech. The actual words have been reproduced.

While reporting or when changing from direct speech, a few changes take place with the reporting verb. But, when the reporting verb is in the present tense, the tense in the reported statement need not be changed.

e.g. Rita says, "I've got admission in a school in Mumbai and I'm moving there next week".

Rita says that she has got admission in a school in Mumbai and is moving there next week.

While reporting statements, we make the following changes.

- Change the pronouns
- Change the tense in the reported statement.

When reporting questions, we use the same word order as in reporting statements.

- The pattern is as follows:
- asked / wanted to know and when, where, how, what, etc.,

E.g. 1. Do you like to dance?
She wanted to know if I liked to dance.

2. Where do you reside?
She asked me where I resided.

Look at the change of time and place when changing from Direct to Indirect Speech.

Direct	Indirect
now	then
today	that day
ago	before
yesterday	the day before
tomorrow	the next day/the following day
next week	the following week

Similarly 'this' becomes 'that'

Change in auxiliary verbs

Here is a list of auxiliary verbs that always change when converting Direct to Indirect Speech.

Direct speech	Indirect speech
can/cannot	could/couldn't
may	might
will/shall	would/should

Here is a list of auxiliary verbs that do not change when converting Direct into Indirect.

Direct speech	Indirect speech
might	might
could	could
need not	need not

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